

1 Kings 12:6,7,8(but)

- Saul, David, Solomon (three kings of Israel)
- What is the role of a leader?
 - To be a role model
 - Encourage people to become better
 - Support people in that journey
 - Remove obstacles
 - Service
- Rehoboam / Jaroboam
- Jezebel = (where is baal?)
- Elijah = jah (jehova) eli (is our god)

1 Kings 17

- 1 Kings 17:1 = calls down a famine
 - People suffering a prone to turn heaven word - God, please help.
- v4-6 = ravens bringing food
 - He is suffering along with the people
 - How easy would it have been for him to unseal the heavens
- v8 = go talk to the widow
 - Notice that Elijah shows up right at the last minute
 - If you were Elijah, how would you have responded?
 - He, in fact, pushes it one step farther...
 - Elijah has to trust that God knows what he's doing
- Whatever we are suffering with there is an act of faith that we have to choose to trust God in the face of our perception of reality where we think that things won't work out.
- So it makes me wonder what this Widow woman *felt*.
 - Would the words cause this woman to do what she did?
 - We don't make lasting changes because of things we see or things we hear, but things we *feel*.
- v14
- v17-23
 - 4th miracle - raising the dead

1 Kings 18

- 1 Kings 18:17,19
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- v21
 - How long halt ye between two opinions?
 - Doubt = duo = two
 - Questions = quest
- v22,23
- v27,28
- v37,38,39
- v41-46
 - 5th miracle - tiny cloud in the distance = move now before you are stuck in the rain

1 Kings 19

- v4 (last part) - discouraged
 - Ever been a time in your life have been going well,
 - but there have still been naysayers
 - and people are refusing to get on board?
 - What a lonely, difficult job...
- v4,5
 - Maybe the important lesson here is being that angel and delivering that life giving substance
 - Maybe they need to be reminded that life is worth living
 - That there is hope
 - That there is help
 - That the heavens are aware of themselves
 - If you ever get those promptings to take something
 - It doesn't need to be food
 - And we think... that's silly, they don't need help.
 - Follow through
 - I mean - Elijah, one of the greatest prophets of all time - he would never need help, right!?
- v10-13
 - Almost imperceptibly small voice
- v19,20
 - A man, with almost no introduction, gives up everything to follow a prophet of God
- How long halt ye between two opinions?
- The call of the world, the loud, the in-your-face voices of the world - they're very alluring.
- The still small voice that often feels outnumbered - 1 vs 450
- Our barrel and our cruise will not fail us, if we put our trust in him.